

Fin AI Agent - lean in Pilot group report

Context

During Q4 2025, a pilot program was run involving seven Tier 1 merchants to see how they could use Fin to replace email for support. The pilot had the full support of the Account Managers. This was very valuable to understand more how the merchant works in terms of operations, ways of working and informing our channel strategy for Fin for these larger merchants.

Participating Merchants:

- eToro
- Plus500
- Sibilla
- Wise
- Bytedance
- Vinted

These merchants were selected based on two key criteria:

1. A significant volume of existing email traffic (~5-10% overall in last 6 months)
2. Issue types where at least 60% were deemed resolvable by Fin.

Both the Account Managers and the merchants received briefing sessions and accompanying briefing packs.

The primary metric tracked during this pilot was the percentage difference between the email channel volume and the Fin channel volume (see below [table](#)).

Of note, the success stories were Plus500 and eToro, who we see have the biggest increase in Fin channel usage (to X% and to Y% respectively).

Outcomes & learnings

Traits and needs of larger merchants:

- Large operational teams who churn (e.g. 50+ people) and often distributed, making centralised process and comms a challenge

- Using multiple PSPs and sophisticated internal tools to consume APIs, accessing all their PSP Dashboards for Operational work is overhead on them
- Dedicated AMs and some TAMs who help them with complex issues
- Our investment in their support pays off in the NR they provide vs the longer tail of merchants

Merchants present significant operational inconsistencies and resistance to change, making the adoption of our Fin AI agent challenging:

- **Inconsistent Merchant operations:** Merchants' internal processes are highly varied and difficult to influence. Without strict enforcement, merchants are unlikely to adjust their operations simply for one of several PSPs, often prioritising convenience.
- **Operational Team Entrenchment:** Merchant operations teams are often resistant to changing established workflows. For instance, some prefer shared email inboxes, which are incompatible with our Dashboard due to MFA (e.g. Wise). The overhead of setting up individual Dashboard accounts is seen as a friction point.
- **Limited Channel Shift:** Despite frequent communication from Account Managers, there has not been a significant shift from email to Fin (X% to Y%). This is often due to poor internal communication on the merchant side, where operational teams do not receive or action messages sent from Account Managers.
- **Access Management Burden:** Larger merchants with big teams view the access controls required for the Dashboard as an operational burden and overhead compared to managing simple team email inboxes.
- **Incomplete Fin Functionality:** Fin currently cannot resolve all merchant queries, necessitating a fallback to email for convenience. Feedback from merchants (e.g., eToro, as detailed [here](#)) indicates that while Fin itself is promising, it is hampered by missing Dashboard features, such as inadequate payment data display and the lack of access to Scheme dispute outcome letters.
- **Fin got great feedback when it solved their issues:** eToro and Plus500 provided great feedback on its usefulness. They both had the simplest issues (payment related) hence this result.
 - eToro: *The AI Agent has been very helpful in understanding codes*
 - Plus500: *I've used the AI several times over the last few weeks and found it to be very helpful. I hope it will be beneficial for the team. It clearly has the potential to save time by cutting down on lengthy emails.*

What does this mean for our Fin plans?

Challenges/insight:

- **Merchant centricity and process:** A standard, one-size-fits-all AI support solution, like the current Fin/Dashboard setup, is not a good experience fit for large merchants.
- **Email entrenchment:** These merchants are unlikely to abandon email organically, as it is deeply integrated into their operational processes, often using central ticketing systems like Zendesk or Freshdesk. Email also offers them convenience. Unless we enforce use of Dashboard, they will not organically switch to using it or Fin.
- **Dashboard Access Management:** The burden of managing user churn and permissions for Dashboard access acts as an overhead and barrier to its adoption by large merchants.

Proposed Solution: Meet Merchants in middle with Fin on Email (Fin resolution cost is same on chat and email)

To bridge the gap, we propose extending Fin's capabilities to email, with solutions designed to drive both resolution and self-serve:

- **Solving Payments Issues:** Fin can address payment-related queries securely over email, provided we approve and implement the necessary data authentication.
- **Incentivise self serve:** Emails should highlight relevant Dashboard solutions to encourage merchants to use our content for self-serve resolutions.
- **Channel prioritisation:** We position Fin within the Dashboard as the fastest channel for query resolution.

Next Steps:

- We can enforce Dashboard for smaller merchants (Tier 3+/Bronze) to streamline their support, as they do not have these operational traits (smaller teams to manage, less dedicated support from us vs ROI)
- Learnings from this pilot are incorporated into the **Care Support success plan** for Enterprise and Premium level merchants (today's Tier 1s/Gold/Silvers)
- The success plan will guide how we deploy Fin on Email and incentivise the use of the chat channel for merchants who are already using the Dashboard.

Results with Fin

Imran Khan to help input stats

Merchant	Fin channel uplift % since pilot	Fin conversations	Fin resolution rates	Escalated issue types
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eToro				
Plus500				
Sibilla				
Wise				
Bytedance				
Vinted				
Overall				

Email vs Fin usage comparison

